

Markdown editors

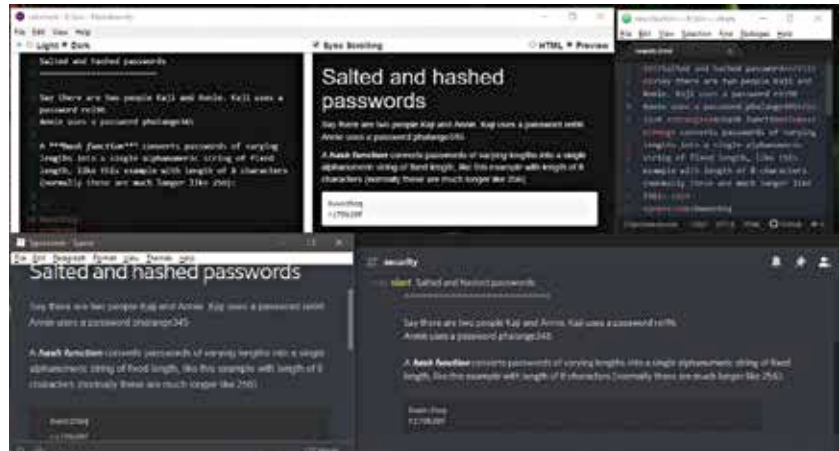
Use this markup language for humans to better format forum posts

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Markdown is a markup language and tool crafted by Swartz and John Gruber as a text to html tool for those writing online. The idea was simple enough, the writer fires up any text editor, uses familiar and basic syntax to format the text, say **bold**, then convert the formatted text into HTML, which adds the relevant brackets and slashes to make it `<b>bold</b>`. The most important consideration for designing markdown was making the syntax readable for humans too, and not appear like code. From the original post announcing the tool, the rationale for Markdown is explained as, "The idea is that a Markdown-formatted document should be publishable as-is, as plain text, without looking like it's been marked up with tags or formatting instructions." To see how it looks when read in more volume, here is a chunk of content in HTML.

```
<h1>Typora</h1>
<h5>Use markdown to better
format your forum posts</h5>
<p>this text is in
<strong>bold</strong>,
<em>italics</em>,
<u>underlined</u>, and
<del>struck out</del></p>
<blockquote><p>this is a
quote </p>
</blockquote>
```

Next, is the same content but in Markdown. The important thing to note here is, that in the text below the intended formatting is easy to



Top right is Markdownify with the dual panel view, showing Markdown on the right and a rendering on the right, the raw HTML code in Atom on the top right, the WYSIWYG markdown interface of Typora on the bottom left and a post on Discord which uses a slightly different flavour of Markdown

understand even though the actual text has itself not been formatted.

Typora
Use markdown to better format your forum posts
this text is in
bold, *italics*,
underlined,
and ~~struck out~~
> this is a quote



Markdown has become very popular over the years, although the specific implementation in each platform is slightly different, resulting in what are known as "flavours" of markdown. Markdown editors are not WYSIWYG editors, and the syntax is not hidden away from the writer. It gives more precise control, and on many platforms allows people to post content that may even be unsupported by the WYSIWYG editor. One the text has been entered, it can be copy pasted into Reddit, Stack Exchange, Wordpress, Discord or Xenforo. Markdown is platform agnostic and future proof, and the best thing is that even if the platform you are posting on does not support it, the resulting text is still comprehensible with the intended

formatting anyway. The specific implementation varies on platforms and the writer has to be aware of flavours.

MARKDOWNIFY

Markdownify is a simple and powerful markdown editor, with a dual panel layout. On the left, the Markdown version is shown, while on the right, the writer can either choose to view the rendered output as a web page, or look at the raw HTML code. There are a number of features that are useful for Markdown editors, such as a livepre-view that changes as and when you add the formatting, and sync scrolling so that you can see which parts of the Markdown correspond to which parts of the HTML. There are some useful features though that make using Markdownify particularly convenient. Unfortunately, neither the documentation nor the interface allows you to access those features in a convenient way, so you have to discover them for yourself using a trial and approach manner. One of the most important features is the support for multiple cursors. For those dealing with complex HTML and CSS documents, this can be